

12 The present perfect continuous

The present perfect continuous is used to talk about a continuing activity in the past that still has an effect on the present moment. It usually refers to the recent past.

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12.1 THE PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

The present perfect continuous describes an activity that took place over a period of time in the recent past. The activity might just have stopped or might still be happening.

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

I have been painting the house all day. I'm exhausted!

The past activity often affects the present moment.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

"I have" can be shortened to "I've."

I've been cooking this evening.
Now I have to do the dishes.



"He has" can be shortened to "He's."

He's been waiting for the bus for an hour.
He is going to be late for work.



HOW TO FORM



Use "have" or "has,"
depending on the subject.

"Been" stays the
same for all subjects.

"-ing" is added to
the main verb.